

WARIS AHMAD FAIZI

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Department of Sociology, Virginia Tech
555 McBryde Hall, 225 Stanger Street, Blacksburg, VA 24061

 Google Scholar  LinkedIn  GitHub  VT Experts

EDUCATION

- | | |
|--------------|--|
| 2024– | Ph.D., Sociology, Virginia Tech
<i>Areas:</i> Economic Sociology; Digital Sociology; Labor, Work, and Organizations
<i>Methods:</i> Quantitative Methods; Computational Social Science |
| Mar–Jul 2024 | Visiting Graduate Student, University of Tübingen, Germany (Erasmus+) |
| 2023 | M.A., Sociology, American University of Central Asia
Exchange semester (Erasmus+), Otto-von-Guericke University Magdeburg, Germany, 2022 |
| 2020 | M.A., Economics, OSCE Academy in Bishkek |
| 2015 | B.A., Economics, Kabul University |

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

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| 2026– | Graduate Research Assistant, Department of Sociology, Virginia Tech |
| Aug. 2026 | Fellow, Summer Institute in Computational Social Science (SICSS), Stanford University |
| Jul.–Aug. 2026 | Teaching Assistant, ICPSR Summer Program in Quantitative Methods, University of Michigan
<i>Course:</i> Categorical Data Analysis: Models for Categorical, Ordinal, and Count Outcomes |
| May–Jun. 2026 | Graduate Research Assistant, Department of Sociology, Virginia Tech |
| 2025–26 | Graduate Teaching Assistant, Department of Sociology, Virginia Tech |
| May–Jul. 2025 | Graduate Research Assistant, Department of Sociology, Virginia Tech |
| 2024–25 | Graduate Teaching Assistant, Department of Sociology, Virginia Tech |

RESEARCH AND PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

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| 2023–24 | Research Consultant, International Finance Corporation (IFC), World Bank Group
October 2023 – May 2024 |
| 2022–23 | Research Intern, Office of the Vice President for Academic Affairs, American University of Central Asia |
| 2020–22 | Intern, Organization for Security and Co-operation in Europe (OSCE) Secretariat
September–October 2020; November 2021 – February 2022 (six months) |
| 2021 | Research Consultant, World Bank Project, Pearl Horizon Consulting |
| 2021 | Research Fellow, Central Asia Program, George Washington University |
| 2021 | Research Intern, Center for Research and Graduate Education (CRGE), Kazakh-German University (DKU) |

AWARDS & HONORS

2026	Dean's Graduate Scholar, College of Liberal Arts and Human Sciences, Virginia Tech Includes the CLAHS Fellowship Award
2026	Center for Humanities Graduate Student Fellowship, Virginia Tech
2025	Patricia and John Edwards Fellowship Award, Virginia Tech
2024	Erasmus+ Exchange Scholarship, University of Tübingen, Germany
2023	German Academic Exchange Service (DAAD) Scholarship, Germany
2023	Student Initiative Development Program Fund, Center for Civic Engagement, American University of Central Asia
2022	Erasmus+ Exchange Scholarship, Otto-von-Guericke University (OVGU), Germany
2021	Central Asia Program Research Fellowship, George Washington University
2021	M.A. Sociology Program Full Scholarship, American University of Central Asia
2019	M.A. Economics Program Full Scholarship, OSCE Academy in Bishkek

PUBLICATIONS

Journal Articles

- J1 **Faizi, W. A.**, Kim, D., Dogan, C., Park, S. & Kim, J. *Mapping Workforce Reskilling Urgency in the Age of AI: Occupational and Geographic Patterns across the United States*. *Telematics and Informatics* **109**, 102445 (2026). <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.tele.2026.102445>

Manuscripts under Review

- R3 Calasanti, T., **Faizi, W. A.** & King, N. *Age Relations and Intersections*. Revise and resubmit at *Sociology Compass*. 2026.
- R2 **Faizi, W. A.** *From Perk to Norm: The Diffusion of Remote Work and the Fading of Its Positional Value*. Revise and resubmit at *Social Currents*. 2026.
- R1 **Faizi, W. A.** *Autonomy, Precarity, and Stratified Returns Across Employment Sectors*. Under review at *Sociological Forum*. 2026.

Manuscripts in Preparation

- M3 **Faizi, W. A.** *Pricing Care Labor: The Devaluation of Bodywork and the Intersectional Division of Reproductive Labor*. Ready for submission. 2026.
- M2 **Faizi, W. A.** *Social Capital and the Timing of Corporate Elite Mobility*. Ready for submission to *Research in Social Stratification and Mobility*. 2026.
- M1 Roos, J. M., **Faizi, W. A.** & Lin, S.-H. *Confidence in Science and Political Institutions, 2010–2024: Four Distinct Patterns of Polarization*. Ready for submission to *Social Science Research*. 2026.

Works in Progress

- W5 **Faizi, W. A.** *Neoliberal Doxa across the World-System: Economic Beliefs in the Global North and South*.
- W4 **Faizi, W. A.** *Not All Moves Are Equal: How Employment and Capital Composition Shape Residential Mobility Strategies*.
- W3 **Faizi, W. A.** *The Moral Economies of Influencer Culture: Visibility, Value, and Intersectional Precarity*.

- W2 **Faizi, W. A.** *Divergent Value Trajectories: Cultural and Economic Liberalization in the United States, 2004–2024.*
- W1 **Roos, J. M., Faizi, W. A. & Lin, S.-H.** *Item Level Bias in the NSF-sponsored Science Knowledge Scale, 2006–2024.*

Research Reports

- P1 **Faizi, W. A.** *The Future of the CASA-1000 Electric Megaproject in the Context of the New Afghanistan.* Central Asia Program, George Washington University (2021). centralasiaprogram.org/archive/central-asia-research-paper/

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- C11 **Faizi, W. A.** *Social Capital and the Timing of Corporate Elite Mobility.* American Sociological Association (ASA), 121st Annual Meeting (New York, NY, USA). Aug. 2026.
- C10 **Faizi, W. A.** *Pricing Care Labor: The Devaluation of Bodywork and the Intersectional Division of Reproductive Labor.* Society for the Study of Social Problems (SSSP), 76th Annual Meeting (New York, NY, USA). Aug. 2026.
- C9 **Faizi, W. A.** *Social Capital and the Geography of Opportunity: Economic Connectedness, Bias, and Mobility in the United States.* Southern Sociological Society (SSS) Annual Meeting (Jacksonville, FL, USA). Apr. 2026.
- C8 **Faizi, W. A.** *Divergent Value Trajectories: Cultural and Economic Liberalization in the United States, 2004–2024.* 42nd Annual GPSS Research Symposium and Exposition, Virginia Tech (Blacksburg, VA, USA). Mar. 2026.
- C7 **Faizi, W. A.** *The Moral Economies of Influencer Culture: Visibility, Value, and Intersectional Precarity.* Eastern Sociological Society (ESS), 96th Annual Meeting (Washington, DC, USA). Mar. 2026.
- C6 **Faizi, W. A.** *Redistribution Gap: Class, Race and Political Ideology in Shaping Attitudes Toward Inequality.* Association for Humanist Sociology (AHS), 49th Annual Meeting (Columbus, OH, USA). Nov. 2025.
- C5 **Faizi, W. A.** *Economic Precarity, Quality of Work Life, and Social Trust: An Empirical Study of the U.S. Workforce (2004–2024).* Society for the Study of Social Problems (SSSP) Annual Meeting (Chicago, IL, USA). Aug. 2025.
- C4 **Faizi, W. A.** *Public, Private, or Personal: Comparative Impacts of Government, Private, and Self-Employment on Job and Financial Satisfaction in the United States.* Canadian Association for Work and Labour Studies (CAWLS) (Hamilton, ON, Canada). May 2025.
- C3 **Faizi, W. A.** *Digital Transformation and Work Paradigm's Shift: Remote Work's Impact on Social Networks and Integration, Well-being, and Economic Stability in the United States.* Southern Sociological Society (SSS) Annual Meeting (Charlotte, NC, USA). Apr. 2025.
- C2 **Faizi, W. A.** *Efficacy of Human Skills Development as a Source of Regional Competitive Advantage and Economic Development in Afghanistan.* South Asian Economics Students' Meet (SAESM) (Colombo, Sri Lanka). Apr. 2016.
- C1 **Faizi, W. A.** *Afghan Carpets' Export Situation: Challenges and Opportunities.* South Asian Economics Students' Meet (SAESM) (Thimphu, Bhutan). Dec. 2014.

TEACHING

ICPSR Summer Program in Quantitative Methods, University of Michigan

2026 Teaching Assistant, Categorical Data Analysis: Models for Categorical, Ordinal, and Count Outcomes, Graduate

Virginia Tech

2024–26 Graduate Teaching Assistant, SOC 1004: Introductory Sociology, Undergraduate

2024–26 Graduate Teaching Assistant, SOC 3204: Social Research Methods, Undergraduate

2024–26 Graduate Teaching Assistant, AFST 1814: Introduction to African Studies, Undergraduate

2024–26 Graduate Teaching Assistant, AFST 4354: Topics in Africana Studies, Undergraduate

Prior Teaching Appointments

2019–21 Lecturer / Instructor, Gawharshad University

2019–21 Lecturer / Instructor, Tolo-e-Aftab Institute of Higher Education

2016–21 Lecturer / Instructor, Sayed Jamaluddin Afghan Institute of Higher Education

2016–18 Lecturer / Instructor, Fanoos Institute of Higher Education

Pedagogical Training

2025–26 Future Professoriate / Global Perspectives Program (GPP), Virginia Tech

- Preparing Future Professoriate (3 credits), Fall 2025
- Contemporary Pedagogy (3 credits), Spring 2026
- Higher Education 360 (3 credits), Spring 2026

SERVICE

Jan.–Jun. 2026 Graduate Research Fellow, Center for Humanities (CfH), Virginia Tech

2023 Career Development Mentor / Trainer, American University of Central Asia

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

Current American Sociological Association (ASA); Southern Sociological Society (SSS); Eastern Sociological Society (ESS); Society for the Study of Social Problems (SSSP); Association for Humanist Sociology (AHS); Pacific Sociological Association (PSA)

Affiliations Stanford Center on Poverty and Inequality (CPI), Stanford University; Dataism Laboratory for Quantitative Finance (DLQF), Virginia Tech; Center for Humanities (CfH), Virginia Tech

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Statistical R, Python, Stata, SPSS, JMP

Other SQL and database management, ArcGIS Online, LaTeX (Overleaf), high-performance computing (Virginia Tech ARC)

ADVANCED METHODS TRAINING

- Summer 2026 ICPSR Summer Program in Quantitative Methods, Inter-university Consortium for Political and Social Research, University of Michigan
- Categorical Data Analysis: Models for Categorical, Ordinal, and Count Outcomes
 - Causal Inference for the Social Sciences II
 - Network Analysis II: Advanced Topics
 - Structural Equation Models with Latent Variables

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT & TRAINING

- 2026 Social Network Analysis, University of California, Davis (Coursera)
- 2026 Causal Inference, Columbia University (Coursera)
- 2026 Social and Economic Networks: Models and Analysis, Stanford University (Coursera)
- 2026 Narrative Economics, Yale University (Coursera)
- 2026 Best Practices for Mentorship in Teaching, Virginia Tech
- 2026 Introduction to Geospatial Mapping and ArcGIS Online, Virginia Tech
- 2026 Manage Your Scholarly Identity Challenge Course, Virginia Tech
- 2026 Connect to ARC Systems with VSCode; Advanced Research Computing Roadmap, Virginia Tech
- 2026 The Joyful Journey: Graduate Student and Postdoctoral Scholar Professional Development Series, CIRTLL
- 2025 Day for Data, AI & Analytics Symposium, Center for the Arts, Virginia Tech
- 2025 Datapalooza 2025: Truth and Accountability in the Age of AI, University of Virginia School of Data Science
- 2025 Preparing for the Academic Job Market Workshop Series, University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill
- 2025 Summer Institute for Undergraduate Education, Virginia Tech
- 2025 Introduction to LaTeX with Overleaf; Introduction to Database Management and SQL, Virginia Tech
- 2024 Social & Behavioral Research, CITI Basic Course
- 2024 Graduate Teaching Assistant (GTA) Workshop Series, Virginia Tech
- 2021–25 Courses in Python and R, LinkedIn Learning and DataCamp

REFERENCES

Toni Calasanti, Ph.D.
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